

that is another great area in which India can and should take the lead.

Q: You speak of Rohtak very fondly. Let me ask what you remember of that time because I believe it was a twist of fate, of you getting a Rotary Foundation scholarship which started you on your global journey...

A: You are absolutely right that the Rotary Foundation scholarship was a stroke of luck and it certainly changed the trajectory of my life. It is really important to never forget where you are from. And I'm from Rohtak, but the Rohtak of my youth is very different from the Rohtak of today. I remember there were only a handful of cars around, Maruti had just come, and I left Rohtak in 1984. So, Rohtak in 1984 was a very different place than it is today. My 82-year-old mother still lives in Rohtak in the same house that I grew up in, and it's truly wonderful to be from that town. When you look back at your life, there are certain inflexion points and the Rotary Foundation scholarship was certainly an inflexion point. Sights unseen, never been on an airplane, never been outside of the country till then. But I got a chance to leave, and it certainly changed my life.

Q: I want to ask you about another issue which is becoming more apparent post-Covid-19. Everywhere, from sports to management circles, there is a lot more talk and awareness about mental health. You yourself faced mental health issues in your career. Perhaps you could talk about that?

A: You have hit on a very important point. The pandemic, and what we all went through over the last two years, has really contributed to mental stress and mental health. You know, I went through it, and

ON INDIA'S OPPORTUNITY

I'm very bullish that it [India] is going to be a multi-faceted growth story. Services are about \$250-300 billion today, and I don't see why it cannot be a trillion-dollar part of the mix. [With] the realignment of global supply chains, India, with its large base of capability and large domestic market, can and should be a destination for resilient supply chains

ON BUSINESSES AND CLIMATE CHANGE

Businesses not only recognise that there is a climate emergency, they are making the effort required to make the change. Could it go faster? Absolutely. Does it require all hands on deck? Absolutely. This cannot be solved by the government or NGOs alone; it has to be solved by the government, NGOs and the business community together

ON MENTAL HEALTH AWARENESS

One of the silver linings from the pandemic was the fact that we started acknowledging and talking about mental health issues and putting it at the right level within a corporation. If you don't have a mentally healthy individual working for your business, you are not going to get their best

back in the '90s we didn't talk about it as openly as we do now. I had been with Deloitte for seven or eight years, and been put up as a Partner, when I decided to step away and take a sabbatical. We call it a sabbatical now, but really it was a leave of absence back in 1994. I spent six months reassessing what I was going to do with my life. I went back to Deloitte, got back on the Partner track [and] became a Partner two years later in 1996. But looking back at my life, that break was central to my mental health, and my ability to recharge and go back and contribute. I would have not been a Partner and certainly would have not reached the Global CEO level at Deloitte if I hadn't taken that break. And I would not have met my future wife. I met her during that break, and she had such a profound impact on my life.

The last two years has impacted all of us, including me. Working through Zoom certainly has its benefits, but not having the ability to interact with people, waking up at ungodly hours and working late into the night has certainly had an impact, and the first thing we need to do is to recognise [that] we need to talk about it; we need to acknowledge that mental health is like any other aspect of health and it needs to be talked about openly. One of the silver linings from the pandemic was the fact that we started acknowledging and talking about mental health issues and putting it at the right level within a corporation. If you don't have a mentally healthy individual working for your business, you are not going to get their best. If my team is not physically and mentally healthy, then they are not going to bring their best self to work, and be able to keep Deloitte ahead of its rivals in a fiercely competitive industry. So, it is again the right business strategy to focus on mental health. **BT**